

Harvey L. Nicholson Jr.

harvey.l.nicholson@hofstra.edu

[Google Scholar](#)

www.harveynicholsonjr.com

Appointments:

Associate Professor of Sociology (status-only), University of Toronto, SGC, 2025-present

Associate Professor of Sociology, Hofstra University, 2024-present

Assistant Professor of Sociology, University of Toronto, SGC, 2022-2024

Assistant Professor of Sociology, University of Florida, 2019-2022

Education:

Ph.D., Sociology, University of Central Florida, 2019

M.A., Sociology, Lehigh University, 2016

B.A., Sociology, West Chester University, 2014

Primary Areas of Research and Teaching:

Substance Use Behaviors

Race, Ethnicity, and Health

Racialization and Racial Attitudes

Medical Sociology

Social Determinants of Health

Mental Health and Well-being

Peer-Review Publications:

Nicholson Jr., H.L. Forthcoming. Prevalence and Social Determinants of Heroin and Illicit Fentanyl Use among Black Women in the United States. *Journal of the National Medical Association*.

Nicholson Jr, H. L. (2025). Prevalence of and Sociodemographic Factors Associated with Prescription Opioid Misuse among Canadian Adults. *Canadian Journal of Addiction*, 16(2), 55-59.

Nicholson Jr, H. L., Yoo, N., Okazaki, S., Chang, D. F., & Craig, M. A. (2025). Inter-minority Relations: Factors Shaping Cognitive and Affective Intergroup Attitudes between Asian and Black Americans. *Social Problems*, spae075.

Owusu-Bempah, A., **Nicholson Jr, H. L.**, Butler, A., Croxford, R., & Kouyoumdjian, F. G. (2023). Opioid toxicity deaths in Black persons who experienced provincial incarceration in Ontario, Canada 2015–2020: A population-based study. *Preventive Medicine*, 177, 107778.

Nicholson Jr, H. L., Alawode, O. A., & Ford, J. A. (2024). Determinants of prescription opioid misuse among Black Americans: evidence from the 2019 National Survey on Drug Use and Health. *Addictive behaviors*, 149, 107890.

Nicholson Jr, H. L. (2023). “Exploring Your Family Roots”: The Association Between Tracing Family Roots and Psychological Well-Being among African Americans. *Journal of African American Studies*, 1-10.

Yoo, N., **Nicholson Jr, H. L.**, Chang, D. F., & Okazaki, S. (2023). Mapping Anti-Asian Xenophobia: State-Level Variation in Implicit and Explicit Bias against Asian Americans across the United States. *Socius*, 9, 23780231231196517.

Nicholson Jr, H. L. (2023). Pan-African identity, psychological well-being, and mental health among African Americans. *Identities*, 1-21.

Alawode, O. A., & **Nicholson Jr, H. L.** (2023). Health literacy and uptake of annual physical checkups among emerging adults in the United States: Findings from the Behavioral Risk Factor Surveillance System. *Sociology Compass*, 17(4), e13081.

Nicholson Jr, H. L. (2023). Social determinants of opioid use behaviors among adults in the United States. *Journal of Substance Use*, 28(3), 371-378.

Nicholson Jr, H. L., & Mei, D. (2023). Predicting group consciousness among Asian Americans: Considering commonalities, shared interests, panethnic group identification, and linked fate. *Sociology Compass*, 17(2), e13051.

Nicholson Jr, H. L. (2023). "I am African American": Racial-ethnic self-designation, self-concept, and major depression among African Americans. *International Journal of Social Psychiatry*, 69(3), 551-558.

Hill, T. D., Ford, J. A., & **Nicholson Jr, H. L.** (2022). Education and polypharmacy: A national study of racial and ethnic variations. *Social Science Quarterly*, 103(7), 1687-1705.

Nicholson Jr, H. L., Wheeler, P. B., Smith, N. C., & Alawode, O. A. (2022). Examining the Relationship between Discrimination and Prescription Drug Misuse: Findings from a National Survey of Black Americans. *Substance Use & Misuse*, 57(7), 1014-1021.

Nicholson Jr, H. L. (2022). Feelings of closeness toward Asian Americans: an analysis of African Americans and Black Caribbeans. *Sociological Spectrum*, 42(1), 1-17.

Assari, S., Boyce, S., Mistry, R., Thomas, A., **Nicholson Jr, H. L.**, Cobb, R. J., ... & Zimmerman, M. A. (2021). Parents' perceived neighborhood safety and children's cognitive performance: Complexities by race, ethnicity, and cognitive domain. *Urban Science*, 5(2), 46.

Assari, S., Boyce, S., Bazargan, M., Thomas, A., Cobb, R. J., Hudson, D., Curry, T., **Nicholson Jr, H. L.** ... & Zimmerman, M. A. (2021). Parental educational attainment, the superior temporal cortical surface area, and reading ability among American children: A test of marginalization-related diminished returns. *Children*, 8(5), 412.

Smith, N. C., & **Nicholson, H. L.** (2022). Perceived discrimination and mental health among African American and Caribbean Black adolescents: Ethnic differences in processes and effects. *Ethnicity & Health*, 27(3), 687-704.

Nicholson Jr, H. L., Ahmmad, Z., Anderson, A., & Doan, T. T. (2022). Unequal returns of employment on self-rated health: Asian-White differences. *Journal of Racial and Ethnic Health Disparities*, 9(4), 1106-1113.

Nicholson Jr., H.L. and Ahmmad Z. (2021). Everyday and Major Discrimination and Self-Rated Health across Ten Asian Ethnic Subgroups. *Annals of Epidemiology* 59, 5-9.

Nicholson Jr, H. L., & Rigg, K. K. (2022). Prescription opioid misuse among Black and White older adults. *Addiction Research & Theory*, 30(1), 25-32.

Nicholson Jr, H. L., & Wheeler, P. B. (2021). Prescription Drug Misuse among African Americans and Afro Caribbeans: Results from the National Survey of American Life. *Substance Use & Misuse*, 56(7), 962-970.

Oh, H., & **Nicholson Jr, H. L.** (2021). Perceived skin tone discrimination and suicidal ideation Black Americans: Findings from the National Survey of American Life. *Journal of Affective Disorders*, 284, 143-148.

Li, Y., & **Nicholson Jr, H. L.** (2021). When “model minorities” become “yellow peril”—Othering and the racialization of Asian Americans in the COVID-19 pandemic. *Sociology compass*, 15(2), e12849.

****Named one of the most cited articles in Sociology Compass in 2020-2021****

Oh, H., **Nicholson Jr, H. L.**, Koyanagi, A., Jacob, L., & Glass, J. (2021). Urban upbringing and psychiatric disorders in the United States: A racial comparison. *International Journal of Social Psychiatry*, 67(4), 307-314.

Nicholson Jr, H. L., & Mei, D. (2020). Racial microaggressions and self-rated health among Asians and Asian Americans. *Race and Social Problems*, 12(3), 209-218.

Nicholson Jr, H. L. (2020). Socioeconomic status, fundamental cause theory, and prescription opioid use behaviors: a theoretical examination. *Sociological Spectrum*, 40(1), 1-32.

Nicholson Jr, H. L. (2020). Associations between major and everyday discrimination and self-rated health among US Asians and Asian Americans. *Journal of Racial and Ethnic Health Disparities*, 7, 262-268.

Nicholson Jr, H. L., Carter, J. S., & Restar, A. (2020). Strength in numbers: Perceptions of political commonality with African Americans among Asians and Asian Americans in the United States. *Sociology of Race and Ethnicity*, 6(1), 107-122.

Rigg, K. K., & **Nicholson Jr, H. L.** (2019). Prescription opioid misuse among African-American adults: A rural-urban comparison of prevalence and risk. *Drug and alcohol dependence*, 197, 191-196.

Nicholson Jr, H. L., & Vincent, J. (2019). Gender differences in prescription opioid misuse among US Black adults. *Substance use & misuse*, 54(4), 639-650.

Nicholson Jr, H. L., & Ford, J. A. (2019). Sociodemographic, neighborhood, psychosocial, and substance use correlates of cocaine use among Black adults: Findings from a pooled analysis of national data. *Addictive Behaviors*, 88, 182-186.

Donley, A. M., & **Nicholson Jr, H. L.** (2019). Comparing the health of relocated public housing residents and current residents of a historically Black community: The moderating role of social cohesion. *Journal of Black Studies*, 50(1), 26-44.

Ford, J. A., Hinojosa, M. S., & **Nicholson Jr, H. L.** (2018). Disability status and prescription drug misuse among US adults. *Addictive Behaviors*, 85, 64-69.

Nicholson Jr, H. L., & Ford, J. A. (2018). Correlates of prescription opioid misuse among Black adults: Findings from the 2015 National Survey on Drug Use and Health. *Drug and alcohol dependence*, 186, 264-267.

Works Submitted, Under Review, and In Progress:

Nicholson Jr., H L. Race First? The Relationship Between Racial Identity Importance and Mental Health among African Americans (*under review*).

Nicholson Jr., H L., Chang D., Okazaki S, and Yoo N. The Role of Media Consumption on Asian Americans' Anti-Black Sentiment: The Mediating Role of Perceptions of Black Americans as a Threat during the COVID-19 Pandemic. (in progress).

Uddin. H, Ahmmad Z., **Nicholson Jr., H.L.,** & Jalal Uddin. The Association between Cumulative Social Risk and Adolescent Obesity: Differences by Race/Ethnicity and Income. (in process).

Rotondo, J., Murray R., Vissandjée B., **Nicholson Jr. H.L.,** VanSteelandt Joanne Chidley A., Jackson B., and Shouting M. The availability of race and ethnicity data within the coroner and medical examiner files of people who died from alcohol acute toxicity in Canada from 2016 to 2017. (in progress).

Grants, Awards, and Fellowships:

Research Grants

Role: consultant. "The impact of structural racism and discrimination on chronic pain in Black or African American older adults: Biopsychosocial mechanisms." (2023). National Institute of Health (NIH).

Role: co-investigator. "Collegiate and national investigation of factors contributing to the lack of Black representation at all levels in veterinary medicine: Measure perceptions on mattering, sense of belonging, college involvement, and socio-academic integrative experiences in order to better understand the experiences of Black veterinary students and our perceived commitment to them." (2020). UF Research 2020 Call for Proposals: Advancing Racial Justice through

Inclusion, Diversity, Equity, and Access at the University of Florida.” Total requested: \$15,000. 2020. Status: funded.

Role: co-investigator. “Racial Discrimination and Racialized Experiences among Hard-to-Reach Populations via New Survey Data.” (2020). Total Award: \$11,000. 2020. Status: funded

Fellowships

“Health Policy Research Scholars.” Funder: Robert Wood Johnson Foundation. Predoctoral Fellowship: Harvey L. Nicholson Jr. Total Award: \$120,000. 2017-2019. Status: funded.

Awards

Teaching Award Nomination. College of Liberal Arts and Sciences. University of Florida. (2021-2022).

Invited talks/Conferences:

Nicholson Jr., Harvey L. Discrimination and Self-rated Health across Asian and Asian American Subgroups. October 19-21, 2020. International Association for Population Health. Virtual due to Covid-19.

Ford, Jason A., Melanie Sberna Hinojosa, and Harvey L. Nicholson Jr. Disability Status and Prescription Drug misuse among U.S. adults. 2018. Society for the Study of Social Problems. Philadelphia, PA.

Restar, Arjee, Kenneth Pass, Harvey L. Nicholson Jr. Grant W. Harper., and Don A. Operario. systematic review of HIV research targeting men who are intimate with transgender women (MITW) in the United States: An emerging field of study. 2017. American Public Health Association. Atlanta, GA.

Nicholson Jr., Harvey L. (presider) and Amy Donley. “Do Perceptions of Neighborhood Safety, Social Cohesion, and Infrastructural Quality Among Relocated Public-Housing Residents and Current Residents within a Historically Black Community Affect Residents’ Physical and Mental Health Status?” 2017. Annual Meeting of the Society for the Study of Social Problems, Montreal, CA.

Nicholson Jr., Harvey L. and Angela Vergara. “Factors Affecting Telemedicine Provision in Mental Health Facilities.” Graduate Research Symposium, 2017. University of Central Florida, Orlando FL.

Nicholson Jr., Harvey L. “Environmental Inequalities within Low-Income and Minority Neighborhoods.” Eastern Sociological Conference. 2014. Baltimore, MD.

Courses Taught:

Hofstra University

SOC 104 Sociology of Health and Medicine
SOC 187 Racial and Ethnic Health Disparities in the U.S.
SOC 134 Race and Ethnicity in the U.S.
SOC 008 Sociology of Drug Abuse

University of Toronto

SOC 394 Social Determinants of Health
SOC 352 Ethnoracial Inequalities in Health
SOC 602 Ethnoracial Inequalities in Health *
SOC 198 Explaining the Persistence of Racialized Inequalities
* graduate course

University of Florida

SYD 3700 Sociology of Race and Racism in the U.S.
SYO 4400 Medical Sociology

University of Central Florida

SYP6555 Sociology of Alcohol and Drugs (instructor of record)
SYP 3551 Patterns of Alcoholism in Society (instructor of record)

Thesis and Dissertation Committees:

Ph.D. Students

University of Florida

Alyssa Nunez
Role: Committee Member

M.A. Students

University of Florida

Sierra Plotner
Role: Chair

University of Florida

Luis Gonzalez-Diaz
Role: Committee Member

University of Toronto

Blossom Cheng
Role: Chair

Service:

Departmental

Hofstra University

- Criminology Search Committee (September 2024-present)
- Department Personnel Committee (September 2024-present)
- Sociology, Criminology, & Anthropology Merger Committee (Spring 2025-present)
- Associate Chair (Spring 2026)

University of Toronto

- Graduate Committee (July 2023-July 2024)
- Society and Technology Search Committee (July 2023-December 2023)
- Comprehensive Exam Committee – Health (July 2023-July 2024)
- Graduate Student Mentor - Maria Gilbert (August 2023-July 2024)
- Program and Curriculum Committee (August 2023-April 2024)

University of Florida

- Graduate Faculty Member (August 2019-August 2022)
- Criminology Graduate Committee Member (2020-2021)
- Graduate Professional Development Seminar – Stephen Perz (September 2020)
- Graduate Population Seminar – Tanya Koropecyk-Cox (September 2021)
- Graduate Publishing Seminar – Chuck Peek and Abby Fagan (April 2021)
- Graduate Student Mentor – Oluwatobi A. Alawode (January 2021 -August 2022)
- AI and Race Search Committee for African American Studies Program (March 2021 – April 2021)
- Graduate Student Mentor- Jiahui Lyu (August 2021 – January 2022)
- AI and Computational Social Science Search Committee (August 2021 -April 2022)

University and College

University of Florida

- Undergraduate Student Organization Faculty Advisor, Health Educational Literacy Organization (2020-2021)
- Faculty Marshal, Winter Graduation (2019)

Discipline

Peer-Reviewed Journal Editorial Board Member

- *Sociological Spectrum* (2021-2024)
- *Society and Mental Health* (2022-2025)

Journal Reviewer

- *Addictive Behaviors*
- *Journal of Ethnicity in Substance Abuse*
- *Drug and Alcohol Dependence*
- *Substance Use & Misuse*
- *Sociology of Race and Ethnicity*
- *Social Work in Public Health*
- *Sociological Forum*

- *Population Research and Policy Review*
- *Social Science & Medicine*
- *Journal of Racial and Ethnic Health Disparities*
- *Social Sciences*
- *Society and Mental Health*
- *Asian Journal of Criminology*
- *Social Problems*
- *The Anthropocene Review*
- *American Sociological Review*
- *Journal of Social Issues*

Professional Affiliations:

Member

- American Sociological Association
- Robert Wood Johnson Foundation

Professional References:

- Available upon request